Text 1

第 1 段

A group of Labour MPs, among them Yvette Cooper, are bringing in the new year with a call to institute a UK "town of culture" award. The proposal is that it should sit alongside the existing city of culture title, which was held by Hull in 2017, and has been awarded to Coventry for 2021. Cooper and her colleagues argue that the success of the crown for Hull, where it brought in £220m of investment and an avalanche of arts, ought not to be confined to cities. Britain's towns, it is true, are not prevented from applying, but they generally lack the resources to put together a bid to beat their bigger competitors. A town of culture award could, it is argued, become an annual event, attracting funding and creating jobs.

直译：包括伊薇特·库珀在内的一批工党议员，以呼吁设立英国“文化之镇”奖的方式迎接新年。他们的建议是，让这一奖项与现有的“文化之城”称号并列；赫尔曾于二〇一七年拥有后者，而二〇二一年的称号已经授予考文垂。库珀及其同事认为，赫尔获得这一桂冠后取得了成功，吸引了二亿二千万英镑投资以及大量艺术活动，而这种成功不应只限于城市。诚然，英国的城镇并没有被禁止申请，但它们通常缺少组织申报、击败更大竞争者的资源。有人认为，“文化之镇”奖可以成为一年一度的活动，吸引资金并创造就业。

第 2 段

Some might see the proposal as a booby prize for the fact that Britain is no longer able to apply for the much more prestigious title of European capital of culture, a sought-after award bagged by Glasgow in 1990 and Liverpool in 2008. A cynic might speculate that the UK is on the verge of disappearing into an endless fever of self-celebration in its desperation to reinvent itself for the post-Brexit world: after town of culture, who knows what will follow—village of culture? Suburb of culture? Hamlet of culture?

直译：有些人可能把这一提议看作一种安慰奖，因为英国已无法申请声望高得多的“欧洲文化之都”称号；这一备受追捧的奖项曾分别于一九九〇年和二〇〇八年被格拉斯哥与利物浦拿下。愤世嫉俗者也许会猜测，英国急于在脱欧后的世界中重塑自身，几乎要陷入无休止的自我庆祝热潮之中：“文化之镇”之后，谁知道还会有什么——“文化之村”？“文化之郊区”？“文化之小村落”？

第 3 段

It is also wise to recall that such titles are not a cure-all. A badly run "year of culture" washes in and washes out of a place like the tide, bringing prominence for a spell but leaving no lasting benefits to the community. The really successful holders of such titles are those that do a great deal more than fill hotel bedrooms and bring in high-profile arts events and good press for a year. They transform the aspirations of the people who live there; they nudge the self-image of the city into a bolder and more optimistic light. It is hard to get right, and requires a remarkable degree of vision, as well as cooperation between city authorities, the private sector, community groups and cultural organisations. But it can be done: Glasgow's year as European capital of culture can certainly be seen as one of a complex series of factors that have turned the city into the powerhouse of art, music and theatre that it remains today.

直译：同时，明智的做法是记住，这类称号并非包治百病的良药。一个经营不善的“文化年”，像潮水一样涌入某个地方，又退去，带来一时的知名度，却没有为当地社区留下持久收益。真正成功的称号获得者，所做的远不止填满酒店客房，或在一年里引入备受瞩目的艺术活动和良好媒体报道。他们改变当地居民的志向与愿望，把城市的自我形象逐渐推向更大胆、更乐观的方向。把这件事做对很难，需要非凡的远见，也需要城市当局、私营部门、社区团体与文化组织之间的合作。但它可以做到：格拉斯哥担任欧洲文化之都的那一年，完全可以被视为一系列复杂因素中的一个，正是这些因素把它变成了如今仍保持活力的艺术、音乐与戏剧中心。

第 4 段

A "town of culture" could be not just about the arts but about honouring a town's peculiarities —helping sustain its high street, supporting local facilities and above all celebrating its people. Jeremy Wright, the culture secretary, should welcome this positive, hope-filled proposal, and turn it into action.

直译：“文化之镇”不仅可以关乎艺术，还可以关乎对一座城镇独特之处的尊重：帮助维系它的主要商业街，支持当地设施，尤其是赞扬当地居民。文化大臣杰里米·赖特应该欢迎这一积极、充满希望的提议，并把它转化为行动。

Text 2

第 1 段

Scientific publishing has long been a licence to print money. Scientists need journals in which to publish their research, so they will supply the articles without monetary reward. Other scientists perform the specialised work of peer review also for free, because it is a central element in the acquisition of status and the production of scientific knowledge.

直译：科学出版长期以来一直是一张“印钞许可证”。科学家需要期刊来发表研究，因此愿意不收取金钱报酬就提供论文。其他科学家也免费承担同行评审这一专业工作，因为它是获得学术地位和生产科学知识的核心环节。

第 2 段

With the content of papers secured for free, the publisher needs only find a market for its journal. Until this century, university libraries were not very price sensitive. Scientific publishers routinely report profit margins approaching 40% on their operations, at a time when the rest of the publishing industry is in an existential crisis.

直译：免费获得论文内容之后，出版商只需要为期刊找到市场。直到本世纪之前，大学图书馆对价格都不太敏感。在出版业其他部分面临生存危机之际，科学出版商却经常报告接近百分之四十的业务利润率。

第 3 段

The Dutch giant Elsevier, which claims to publish 25% of the scientific papers produced in the world, made profits of more than £900m last year, while UK universities alone spent more than £210m in 2016 to enable researchers to access their own publicly funded research; both figures seem to rise unstoppably despite increasingly desperate efforts to change them.

直译：荷兰巨头爱思唯尔声称，它出版了全球百分之二十五的科学论文，去年利润超过九亿英镑。而仅英国大学在二〇一六年就花费了超过二亿一千万英镑，让研究者能够阅读他们自己那些由公共资金资助的研究成果。尽管改变这一状况的努力越来越急切，这两个数字似乎仍在不可阻挡地上升。

第 4 段

The most drastic, and thoroughly illegal, reaction has been the emergence of Sci-Hub, a kind of global photocopier for scientific papers, set up in 2012, which now claims to offer access to every paywalled article published since 2015. The success of Sci-Hub, which relies on researchers passing on copies they have themselves legally accessed, shows the legal ecosystem has lost legitimacy among its users and must be transformed so that it works for all participants.

直译：最激烈、也完全违法的反应，是 Sci-Hub 的出现。它类似一个全球科学论文复印机，成立于二〇一二年，如今声称可以让人获取自二〇一五年以来发表的每一篇付费墙后的文章。Sci-Hub 依靠研究者传递他们自己已合法获取的论文副本。它的成功表明，现行法律框架下的生态系统已经在用户中丧失了正当性，必须加以改造，使其为所有参与者服务。

第 5 段

In Britain the move towards open access publishing has been driven by funding bodies. In some ways it has been very successful. More than half of all British scientific research is now published under open access terms: either freely available from the moment of publication, or paywalled for a year or more so that the publishers can make a profit before being placed on general release.

直译：在英国，向开放获取出版的转变由资助机构推动。在某些方面，这一转变非常成功。如今，英国一半以上的科学研究都按开放获取条件发表：要么从发表之时起就可免费获取，要么先设置一年或更久的付费墙，使出版商获利后，再向公众开放。

第 6 段

Yet the new system has not yet worked out any cheaper for the universities. Publishers have responded to the demand that they make their product free to readers by charging their writers fees to cover the costs of preparing an article. These range from around £500 to $5,000, and apparently the work gets more expensive the more that publishers do it. A report last year pointed out that the costs both of subscriptions and of these “article preparation costs” had been steadily rising at a rate above inflation.

直译：然而，新制度并没有让大学花费更少。面对要求产品向读者免费的呼声，出版商的回应是向作者收费，以覆盖文章制作成本。这些费用从约五百英镑到五千美元不等，而且显然出版商做得越多，这项工作反而越贵。去年的一份报告指出，订阅费用与这些“文章制作费用”一直以高于通货膨胀的速度稳步增长。

第 7 段

In some ways the scientific publishing model resembles the economy of the social internet: labour is provided free in exchange for the hope of status, while huge profits are made by a few big firms who run the market places. In both cases, we need a rebalancing of power.

直译：在某些方面，科学出版模式类似社交互联网的经济模式：人们免费提供劳动，以换取获得地位的希望，而运营这些市场的少数大公司赚取巨额利润。在这两种情况下，我们都需要重新平衡权力。

Text 3

第 1 段

Progressives often support diversity mandates as a path to equality and a way to level the playing field. But all too often such policies are an insincere form of virtue-signaling that benefits only the most privileged and does little to help average people.

直译：进步派常常支持强制性多样化要求，把它视为实现平等、创造公平竞争条件的一条道路。但是，这类政策却往往是一种不真诚的道德姿态展示，只让最享有特权的人获益，对普通人几乎没有帮助。

第 2 段

A pair of bills sponsored by Massachusetts state Senator Jason Lewis and House Speaker Pro Tempore Patricia Haddad, to ensure "gender parity" on boards and commissions, provide a case in point.

直译：马萨诸塞州参议员杰森 · 刘易斯与众议院临时议长帕特里夏 · 哈达德提出的两项法案，旨在确保各委员会中的 " 性别均等 "，恰好就是一个例子。

第 3 段

Haddad and Lewis are concerned that more than half the state-government boards are less than 40 percent female. In order to ensure that elite women have more such opportunities, they have proposed imposing government quotas. If the bills become law, state boards and commissions will be required to set aside 50 percent of board seats for women by 2022.

直译：哈达德与刘易斯担忧，州政府超过一半的委员会中，女性比例不足百分之四十。为了确保精英女性拥有更多此类机会，他们提议由政府强制设置配额。如果这些法案成为法律，到二〇二二年，州政府各委员会将必须为女性预留百分之五十的席位。

第 4 段

The bills are similar to a measure recently adopted in California, which last year became the first state to require gender quotas for private companies. In signing the measure, California Governor Jerry Brown admitted that the law, which expressly classifies people on the basis of sex, is probably unconstitutional.

直译：这些法案类似加利福尼亚州最近采取的一项措施。去年，加州成为第一个要求私营公司实行性别配额的州。在签署这项措施时，加州州长杰里 · 布朗承认，这部明确按性别对人进行分类的法律，很可能违宪。

第 5 段

The US Supreme Court frowns on sex-based classifications unless they are designed to address an "important" policy interest. Because the California law applies to all boards, even where there is no history of prior discrimination, courts are likely to rule that the law violates the constitutional guarantee of "equal protection".

直译：美国最高法院不赞成基于性别的分类，除非这种分类是为了处理一项 " 重要的 " 政策利益。由于加州法律适用于所有董事会，甚至包括从无歧视历史的董事会，法院很可能裁定该法违反了宪法对 " 平等保护 " 的保障。

第 6 段

But are such government mandates even necessary? Female participation on corporate boards may not currently mirror the percentage of women in the general population, but so what?

直译：但是，这种政府强制要求究竟是否有必要？目前，公司董事会中女性的参与比例，或许没有反映女性在总人口中的比例，但那又如何？

第 7 段

The number of women on corporate boards has been steadily increasing without government interference. According to a study by Catalyst, between 2010 and 2015 the share of women on the boards of global corporations increased by 54 percent.

直译：在没有政府干预的情况下，公司董事会中的女性人数一直在稳步增加。根据 Catalyst 的一项研究，二〇一〇年至二〇一五年间，全球企业董事会中的女性比例提高了百分之五十四。

第 8 段

Requiring companies to make gender the primary qualification for board membership will inevitably lead to less experienced private sector boards. That is exactly what happened when Norway adopted a nation-wide corporate gender quota.

直译：要求公司把性别作为董事会成员资格的首要条件，将不可避免地导致私营部门董事会经验减少。挪威实施全国性的企业性别配额时，发生的正是这种情况。

第 9 段

Writing in The New Republic, Alice Lee notes that increasing the number of opportunities for board membership without increasing the pool of qualified women to serve on such boards has led to a “golden skirt” phenomenon, where the same elite women scoop up multiple seats on a variety of boards.

直译：艾丽斯 · 李在《新共和》撰文指出，增加董事会任职机会，却没有扩大具备相应资格的女性人才库，导致了一种“金裙子”现象：同一批精英女性在各种董事会中取得多个席位。

第 10 段

Next time somebody pushes corporate quotas as a way to promote gender equity, remember that such policies are largely self-serving measures that make their sponsors feel good but do little to help average women.

直译：下一次，当有人把企业配额作为促进性别平等的方式来推动时，请记住：这类政策在很大程度上是自利措施，让发起者自我感觉良好，却几乎无助于普通女性。

Text 4

第 1 段

Last Thursday, the French Senate passed a digital services tax, which would impose an entirely new tax on large multinationals that provide digital services to consumers or users in France. Digital services include everything from providing a platform for selling goods and services online to targeting advertising based on user data, and the tax applies to gross revenue from such services. Many French politicians and media outlets have referred to this as a "GAFA tax," meaning that it is designed to apply primarily to companies such as Google, Apple, Facebook and Amazon-in other words, multinational tech companies based in the United States.

直译：上星期四，法国参议院通过了一项数字服务税，将对向法国消费者或用户提供数字服务的大型跨国公司征收一种全新的税。数字服务包括为网上销售商品和服务提供平台，以及根据用户数据投放定向广告等各种内容；该税适用于这些服务带来的总收入。许多法国政治人物和媒体机构把它称为"GAFA 税"，意思是它主要针对谷歌、苹果、脸书和亚马逊等公司，也就是总部设在美国的跨国科技企业。

第 2 段

The digital services tax now awaits the signature of President Emmanuel Macron, who has expressed support for the measure, and it could go into effect within the next few weeks. But it has already sparked significant controversy, with the United States trade representative opening an investigation into whether the tax discriminates against American companies, which in turn could lead to trade sanctions against France.

直译：数字服务税目前正等待总统埃马纽埃尔·马克龙签字；他已经表示支持这项措施，而该税可能在未来几周内生效。但它已经引发重大争议：美国贸易代表已开始调查，这项税收是否歧视美国公司，而这又可能导致美国对法国实施贸易制裁。

第 3 段

The French tax is not just a unilateral move by one country in need of revenue. Instead, the digital services tax is part of a much larger trend, with countries over the past few years proposing or putting in place an alphabet soup of new international tax provisions. They have included Britain's DPT (diverted profits tax), Australia's MAAL (multinational anti-avoidance law), and India's SEP (significant economic presence) test, to name but a few. At the same time, the European Union, Spain, Britain and several other countries have all seriously contemplated digital services taxes.

直译：法国的这项税收，不只是某个需要收入的国家采取的单边行动。相反，数字服务税是一股大得多的趋势的一部分。过去几年，各国提出或实施了大量缩略名称纷繁的国际税收新规定，例如英国的 DPT（转移利润税）、澳大利亚的 MAAL（跨国反避税法），以及印度的 SEP（显著经济存在）测试，这还只是其中几个例子。与此同时，欧盟、西班牙、英国和另外几个国家，都认真考虑过数字服务税。

第 4 段

These unilateral developments differ in their specifics, but they are all designed to tax multinationals on income and revenue that countries believe they should have a right to tax, even if international tax rules do not grant them that right. In other words, they all share a view that the international tax system has failed to keep up with the current economy.

直译：这些单边举措在具体细节上有所不同，但目的都是对跨国公司那些有关国家认为自己有权征税的所得与收入征税，即使国际税收规则并未赋予它们这种权利。换句话说，它们都持有同一个看法：国际税收体系未能跟上当前经济的发展。

第 5 段

In response to these many unilateral measures, the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) is currently working with 131 countries to reach a consensus by the end of 2020 on an international solution. Both France and the United States are involved in the organization's work, but France's digital services tax and the American response raise questions about what the future holds for the international tax system.

直译：为回应这些众多的单边措施，经济合作与发展组织（OECD）目前正与一百三十一个国家合作，力争在二〇二〇年年底之前就一种国际解决方案达成共识。法国和美国都参与了该组织的工作，但法国的数字服务税以及美国的回应，使人们对国际税收体系的未来产生疑问。

第 6 段

France's planned tax is a clear warning: Unless a broad consensus can be reached on reforming the international tax system, other nations are likely to follow suit, and American companies will face a cascade of different taxes from dozens of nations that will prove burdensome and costly.

直译：法国计划征收的税，是一个明确的警告：除非能就改革国际税收体系达成广泛共识，否则其他国家很可能效仿，而美国公司将面临来自数十个国家接连出现的各种税收，这些税收将带来沉重负担和高昂成本。